

Introducing LinkedIn Mentorship Program

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Intro Summary

LinkedIn connects millions of professionals, but lacks a dedicated, structured mentorship system that helps users find, match, and engage with mentors or mentees effectively

The Problem

Many professionals — especially students and early-career individuals — struggle to find trustworthy mentors on LinkedIn. Existing interactions are informal, inconsistent, and lack follow-up mechanisms.

Pain Points:

- Hard to find the *right* mentor (by skills, goals, or domain).
- No verified credibility or structured process.
- Time constraints and unclear mentorship goals.

The Goal

To design an integrated Mentorship Program within LinkedIn that enables structured, goal-oriented mentor–mentee relationships while maintaining the platform’s trust and professional tone.

Key Objectives:

- Help users **find relevant mentors** easily.
- Build **trust** through verified mentor profiles.
- Simplify **communication and scheduling** through in-app integration.

The Solution

Introduce a **Mentorship Feature** inside LinkedIn’s ecosystem, combining smart mentor-matching, verified profiles, progress tracking, and seamless chat/scheduling.

Feature Highlights:

- “Find a Mentor” option in *My Network* tab.
- Smart matching based on skills, interests, and career goals.
- Dedicated “Mentorship Dashboard” for ongoing sessions.
- Calendar and messaging integration.
- Reputation badges for mentors.



Research Objective — Understanding User Needs & Behavior

Before designing the LinkedIn Mentorship feature, it was essential to understand *how users currently approach mentorship*, what challenges they face, and what expectations they have from such a program. The goal was to build empathy and uncover insights that guide a human-centered design solution.

Core Research Objectives

No.	Objective	Explanation
①	Understand Mentorship Needs	Identify why users seek mentors or mentees — career growth, skill learning, or networking.
②	Identify Current Pain Points	Analyze barriers in finding or maintaining mentorship relationships on LinkedIn or elsewhere.
③	Explore User Motivations	Understand what drives people to become mentors or mentees — recognition, impact, learning.
④	Define Expectations for an Ideal Platform	Discover what features users want — matching, verification, scheduling, feedback.

Sample Research Questions

- What best describes your current professional stage?
- Have you ever sought or provided mentorship on LinkedIn (formally or informally)?
- What is your main motivation for joining a mentorship program?
- How would you prefer mentorship sessions to take place?
- What challenges have you faced (or expect to face) in finding a mentor/mentee?
- What feature would you find most valuable in a LinkedIn Mentorship Program?
- How often would you be willing to engage in mentorship sessions?



Research Methodology

To design a mentorship feature that truly resonates with LinkedIn users, a **mixed-methods research approach** was used — combining surveys, interviews, and competitor benchmarking. This helped capture both *quantitative data* (what users do) and *qualitative insights* (why they do it).

Research Methods Used

Method	Type	Purpose
Online Survey	Quantitative	To understand user behavior, preferences, and mentorship goals
User Interviews	Qualitative	To explore emotional drivers, pain points, and expectations

Target Participants

User Groups:

- Students and Early-career Professionals** — seeking career guidance
- Mid-level Professionals** — open to mentoring and networking
- Industry Experts** — motivated to share knowledge and build reputation

Demographics:

- Age Range:** 20–40 years
- Regions:** India
- Platform Usage:** Active LinkedIn users (3–7 years avg. experience)



Key Research Insights — Understanding User Challenges & Opportunities

Following the completion of surveys, interviews, and an analysis of competitors, numerous common themes became apparent. These findings illustrate the genuine needs, challenges, and hopes of LinkedIn users in relation to mentorship, directing us toward impactful design choices.

No.	Insight Title	Description
1	Mentorship Experience on LinkedIn	Most respondents haven't yet engaged in mentorship on LinkedIn , showing a strong opportunity to create awareness and structured programs.
2	Motivation for Joining a Mentorship Program	The primary drive is career advancement , but many also seek confidence and community — programs should balance skill-building with emotional support
3	Preferred Mentorship Format	Users favor interactive, live sessions — suggesting LinkedIn should support real-time mentoring features like integrated video and flexible scheduling.
4	Common Challenges	Pain points revolve around trust, structure, and time management — areas LinkedIn can solve with smart matching algorithms and in-app scheduling tools.
5	Most Desired Features	Participants value credibility and convenience — LinkedIn's integration potential makes it ideal for these features.



Overall Summary

Participants see mentorship as a **career accelerator** but lack a **trusted, structured platform** to connect effectively.

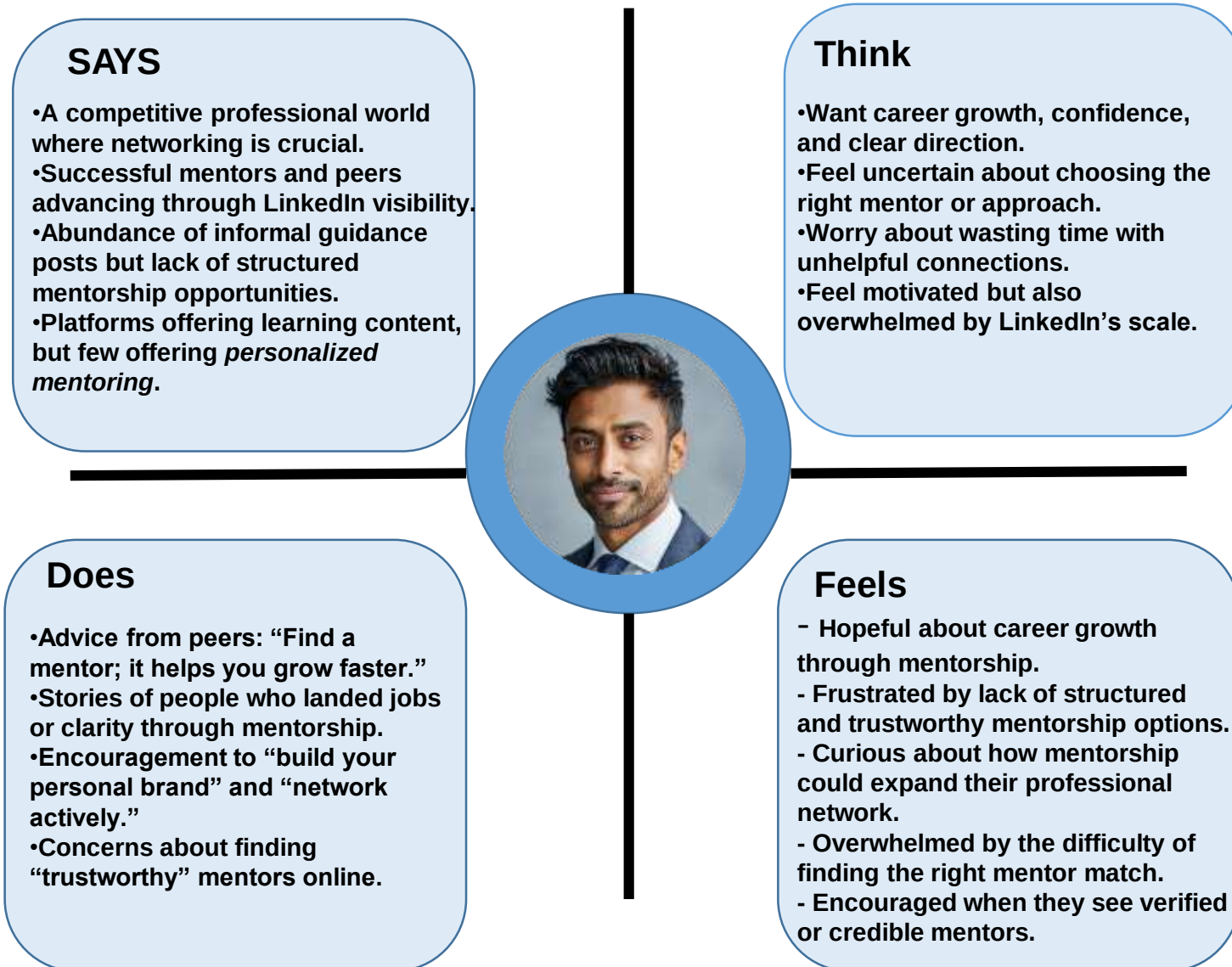
They desire:

- Verified mentors,
- Smart matching systems,
- Integrated communication tools,
- Flexible engagement models.



Empathy Map

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PERSONA-1



Age: 32
Occupation: Product Manager
Location: Bengaluru, India

BIO

He is a Product Manager at a fintech startup in Bengaluru with over 10 years of experience. He enjoys sharing his knowledge through LinkedIn posts and webinars. However, he finds it challenging to handle random mentorship requests and prefers a more structured system.

Arjun Sharma

Needs

- A filtered list of mentees who match his domain and availability.
- Recognition (badges, feedback, or credibility points) for his mentorship.
- Tools to manage time, sessions, and communication easily.

Goals

- Give back to the community by mentoring young professionals.
- Build his professional reputation and visibility.
- Manage mentorship sessions efficiently within his LinkedIn workflow.



PERSONA-2



Age: 22
Occupation: Final yr student
Location: Delhi, India

BIO

She is a final-year design student. She's highly active on LinkedIn, follows thought leaders, and has completed multiple LinkedIn Learning courses. However, she struggles to find genuine human guidance for her career direction and portfolio development.

Riya Sharma

Needs

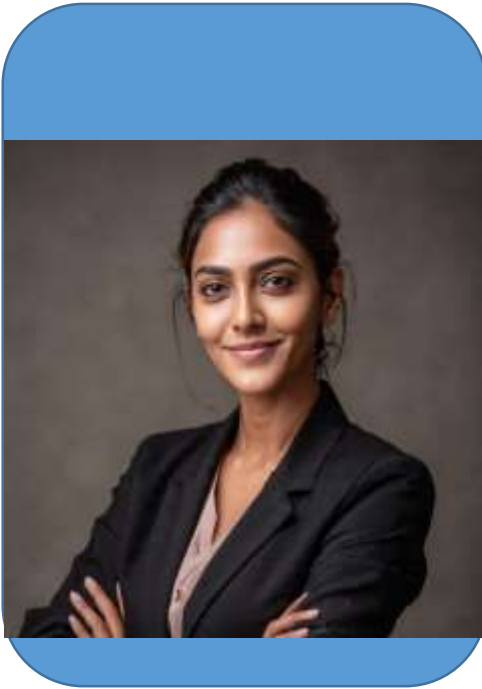
- Access to verified, approachable mentors.
- Structured mentorship sessions with clear objectives.
- A safe, trusted space to ask questions and get feedback.

Goals

- Get mentorship from experienced professionals in the UX industry.
- Build a clear roadmap for entering the job market.
- Gain confidence in her professional identity.



PERSONA-3



Age: 29

Occupation: Career Switcher

Location: Bengaluru, India

BIO

She, is a marketing executive planning to transition into data analytics. She's active on LinkedIn, follows influencers in analytics, and occasionally guides interns in her current company. She's both a learner and a guide, depending on the topic.

Neha Verma

Needs

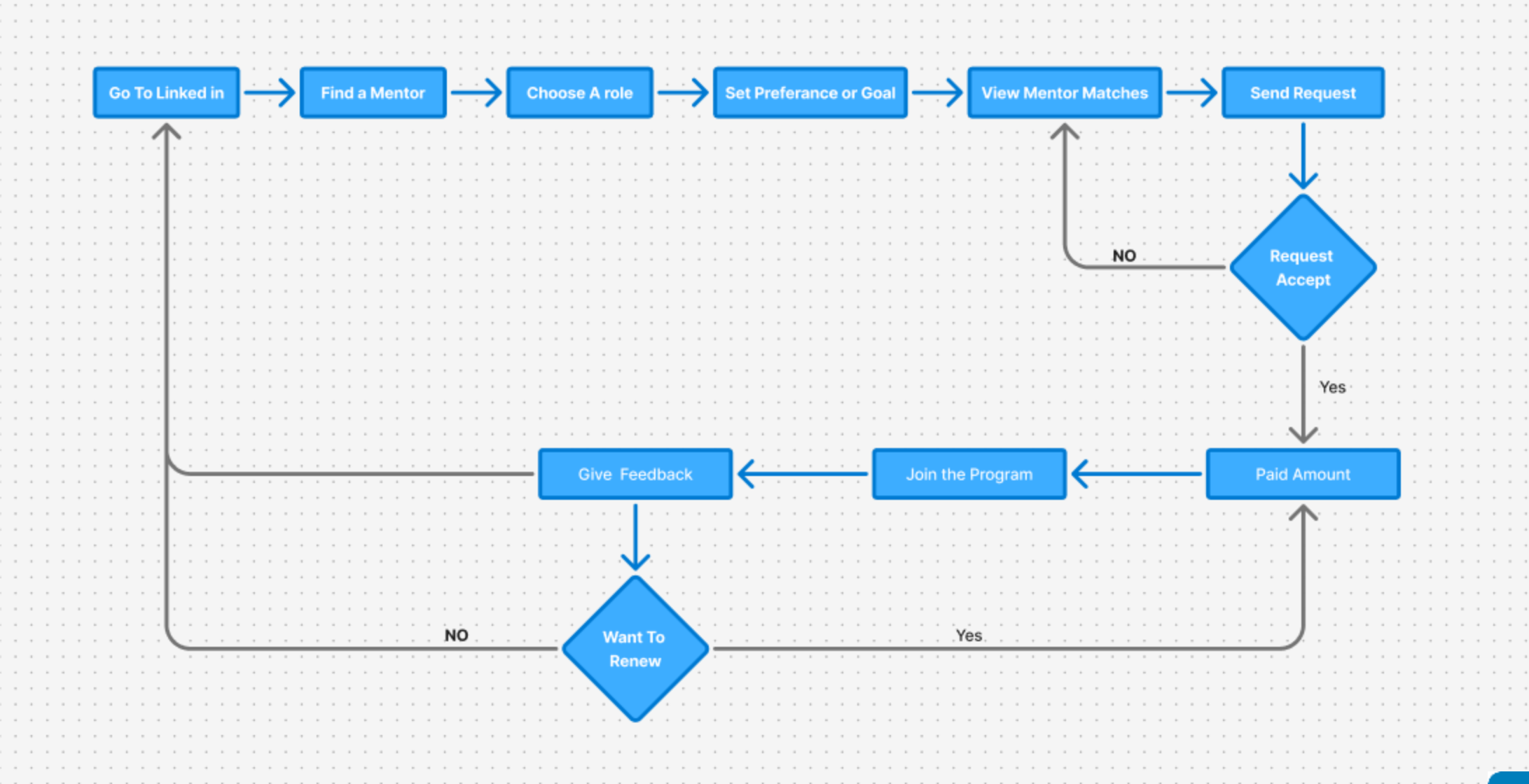
- Mentorship matching based on career transition goals.
- Dual-role support (mentor & mentee).
- Learning resources integrated into the mentorship journey

Goals

- Find mentors who can help her transition careers smoothly.
- Connect with peers who share similar career-switch journeys.
- Eventually mentor others once she gains expertise in analytics.

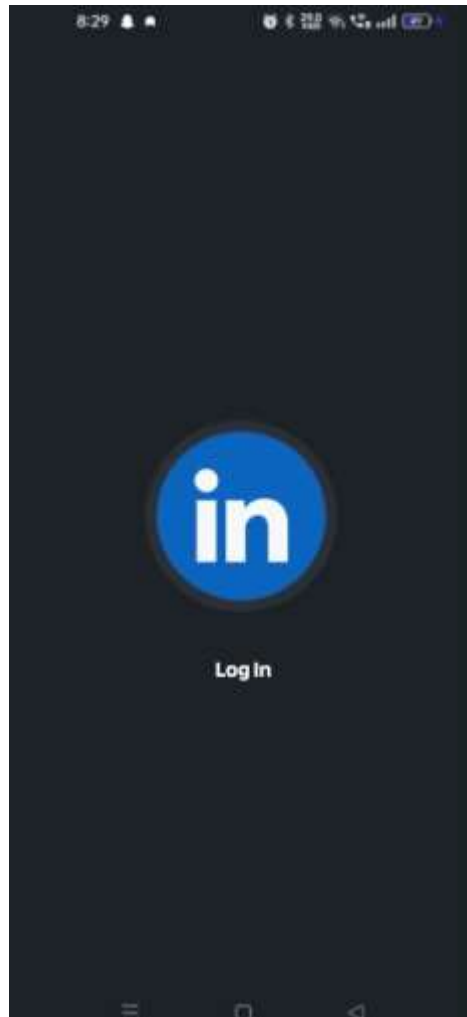


User Flow Diagram

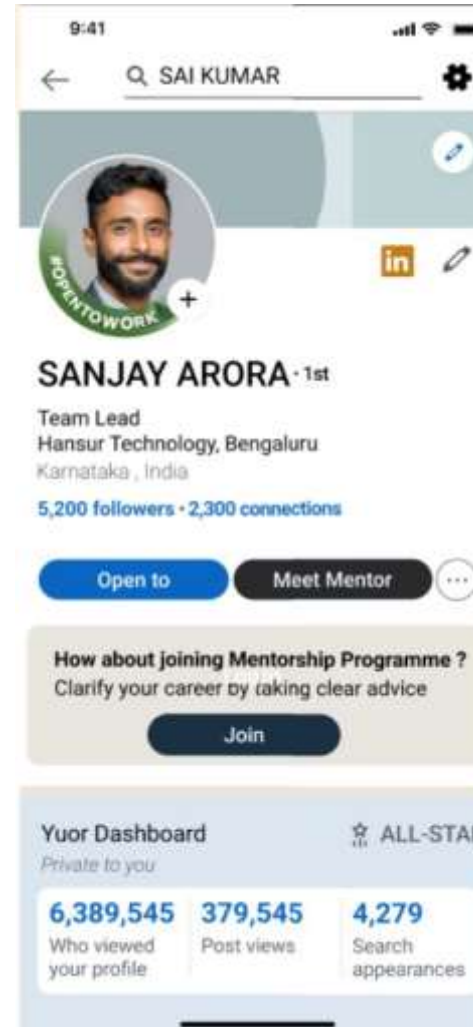


HI-FI Design System

Link: <https://www.figma.com/design/jusxi0Nn7oEwM1cFo1huL7/Linkedin-Mentorship-UI-design-Jaya?node-id=0-1&t=oqPJdMmkuYusGXNL-1>



Login Page

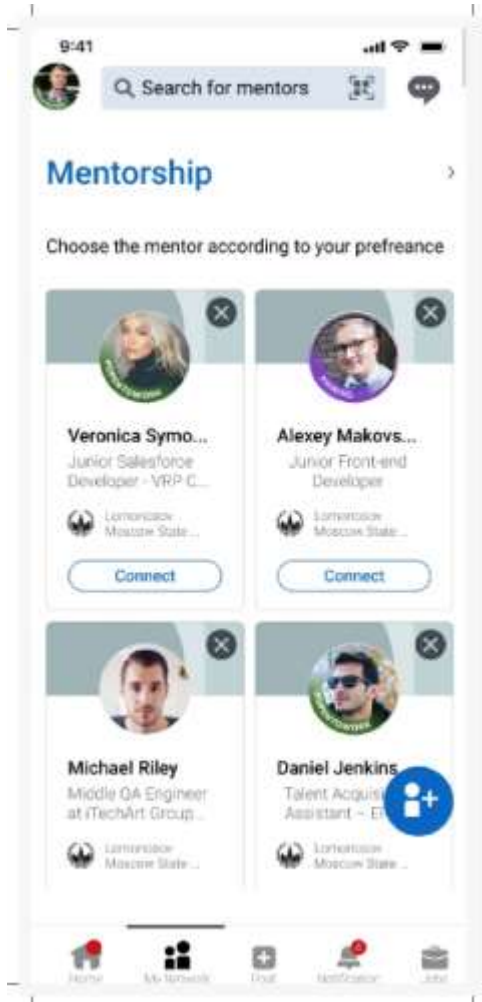


Home Page

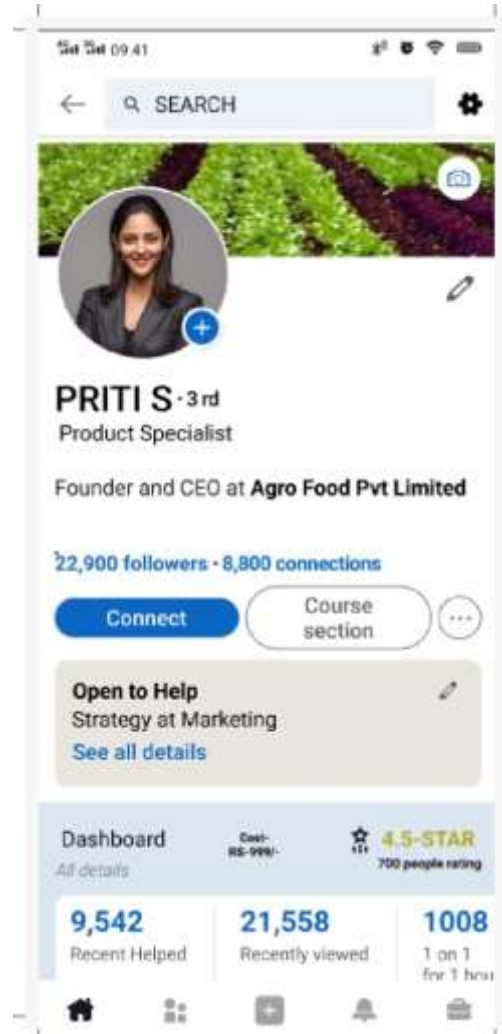


Mentorship Page

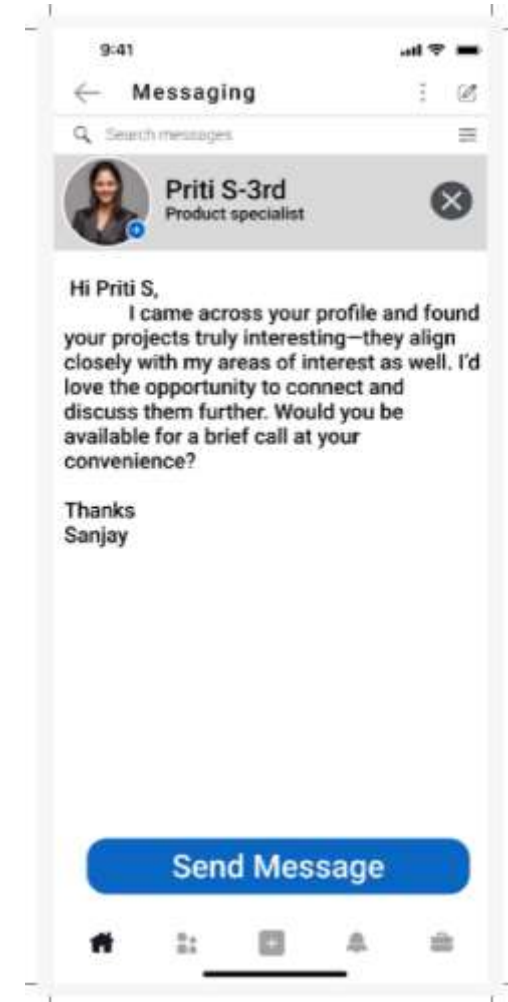




Mentorship

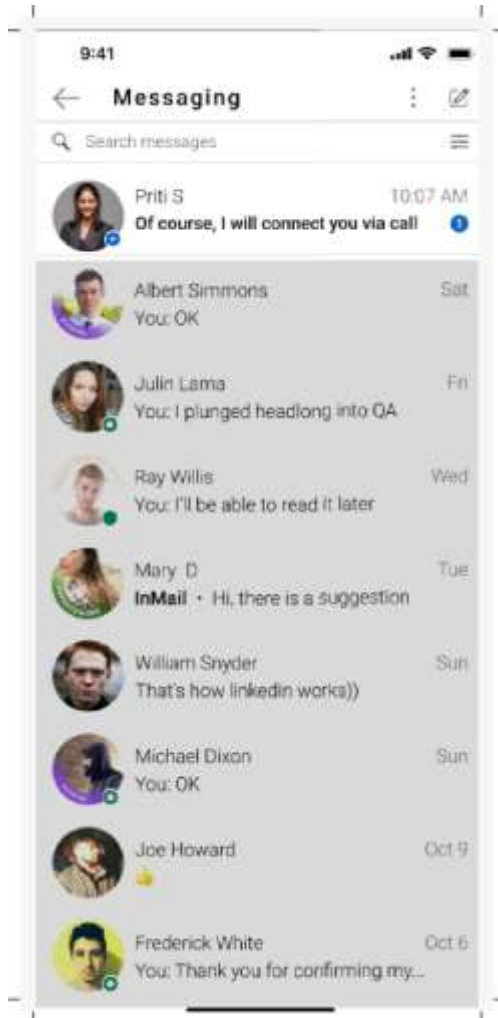


Mentors Profile

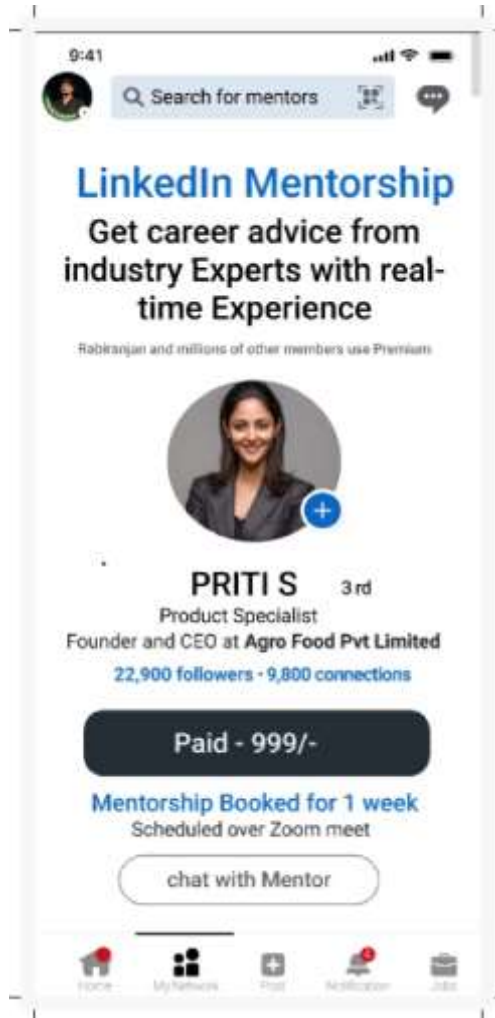


Message to Mentors

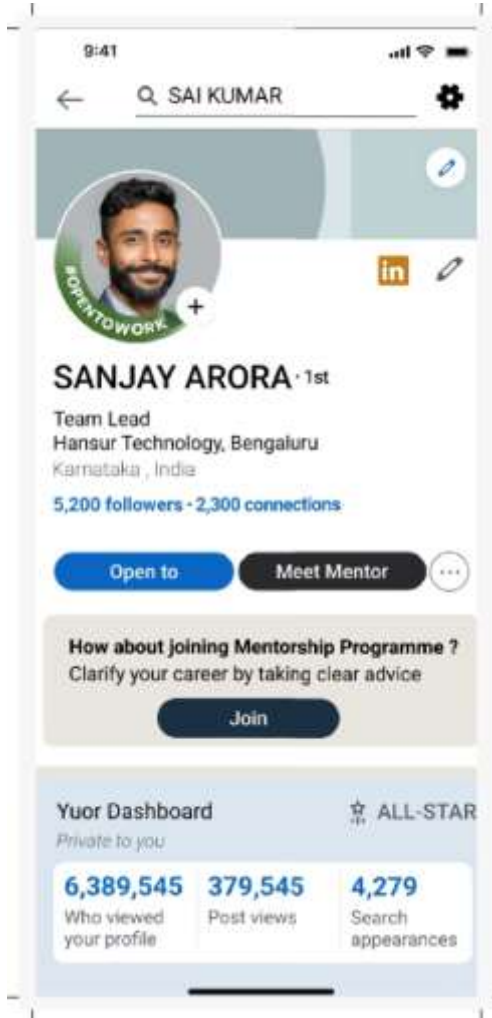




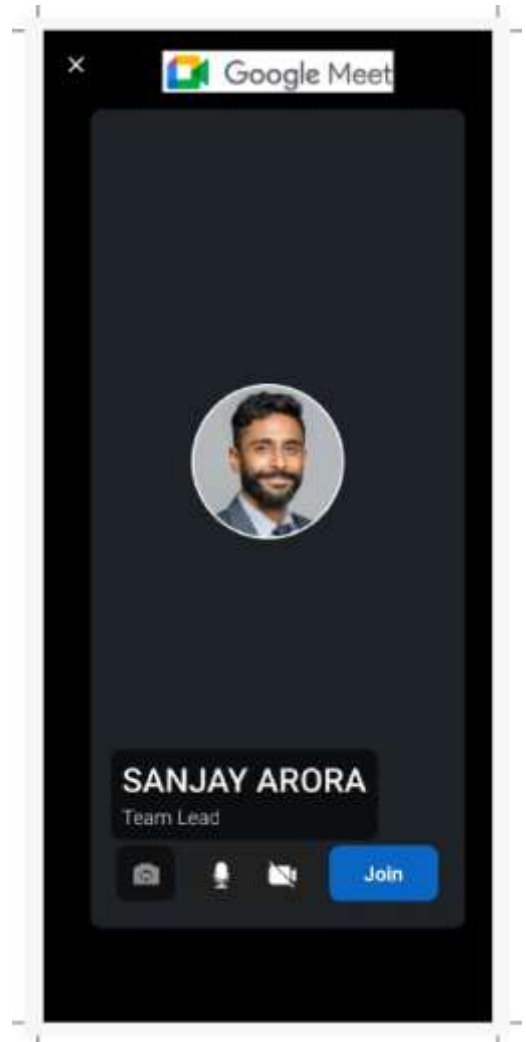
Messaging



Purchase



After Purchase LinkedIn profile



meeting



THANK YOU.....